

FREE PATTERN

Free Crochet Cowl Pattern for Beginners

A closed loop worked in half double crochet, no ties or ends to manage — just slip it over your head.

Updated 2026 · US terms · One adult size, adjustable circumference



This cowl is worked as a tube in continuous rounds, the same spiral technique as our [beanie pattern](#), just left open at both ends instead of closed at the top. Half double crochet keeps it soft and warm without being bulky.

MATERIALS

- 2 skeins worsted-weight yarn (about 200–250 yards total)
- 5.5mm (US size I) crochet hook
- Stitch marker, to track the start of each round
- Scissors
- Yarn needle, for weaving in ends

ABBREVIATIONS (US TERMS)

ABBR.

MEANS

ch	Chain
hdc	Half double crochet
st(s)	Stitch(es)
rnd(s)	Round(s)

See our [abbreviations glossary](#) for the full list including UK terms.

 Crochet hook with yarn mid-project

GAUGE

12 hdc and 10 rows measures about 4in / 10cm square with a 5.5mm hook and worsted yarn. The finished circumference depends directly on your starting chain — measure loosely around the neck and shoulders before starting.

NOTES

- Written in US terms, worked in a continuous spiral — use a stitch marker to track round starts, same technique as our [beanie pattern](#).

- The numbers below make a single-loop cowl that sits at the collarbone; see the FAQ for how to size up to a double loop.
- Check the starting chain against the wearer before joining into a round — it should slip over the head comfortably.

Pattern

ROUND 1

Ch 60, join with a sl st to form a ring, being careful not to twist the chain. Place marker. *(60 sts)*

ROUNDS 2–14

Hdc in every st around. *(60 sts each round)*

Continue until the cowl measures about 9in / 23cm tall, roughly 14 rounds for this gauge.

FINISHING

Fasten off and weave in all ends with a yarn needle.

Frequently asked questions

What is the difference between a cowl and a scarf?

A cowl is a closed loop that slips over the head, while a scarf is a flat, open strip that gets wrapped and tied. Cowls tend to stay in place better and have no loose ends to manage.

How much yarn do I need for a crochet cowl?

A single-loop cowl uses roughly 200 to 250 yards of worsted-weight yarn, comfortably within two standard skeins.

Can I make this cowl pattern longer for a double loop?

Yes, work more rounds before joining to create a longer tube that wraps twice around the neck, roughly doubling the round count and yarn needed.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.